

Decision tree: Designing a static map

Which decision
are you making?

what to draw

layer order

context first, subject last
`geom_sf()` ~ `tm_shape()` + a geometry

how to encode
the value

the visual variable

for these maps, polygon: fill; point: size,
color or shape; line: color or width

how to classify
a continuous value

the scale

every value its own color, or classes from
`tm_scale_intervals(style = )`

which colors

the palette

sequential for a low-to-high variable; diverging
around a midpoint; categorical for groups; check
the palette for color vision deficiency

what the reader
needs to read it

the map elements

title and legend for encoded values; `tm_compass()`
if orientation is unclear; `tm_scalebar()` where
scale variation is small; `tm_credits()` for sources

how to compare
groups

facets

`facet_wrap()` ~ `tm_facets_wrap()`
shared scale for absolute comparisons by color